



Ubuntu Mobile in 2014

Canonical, the makers of Ubuntu for desktop have said that they will release an Ubuntu based smartphone in the year 2014



Acer launching Iconia B1

Acer is going to launch its new Android 4.1 Jelly Bean based tablet, the Acer Iconia B1 in India soon for ₹7,999

Cameras Test

HOW WE TESTED

The goal of our test this time was to determine which camera would give the best image quality, not only at varying ISO's, but also at varying apertures. In DSLR lenses, the common notion is that a lens isn't delivering optimum sharpness at the widest aperture and therefore, requires the lens to be stopped down by almost a stop to get to that sweet spot of ultimate sharpness. We wanted to see whether the same would apply to the point and shoot cameras as well. As a camera that's going to go everywhere with you, we also wanted to make sure the video feature on these

little shooters was up to the task. All cameras were tested using SanDisk Extreme Pro SDXC UHS-I memory card (64 GB). We divided our tests into three parts: two for stills and one for video. One set of tests involved shooting a simulated test target in controlled light to measure color depth/accuracy, white balance accuracy and lens sharpness in the corners and center. A controlled test target also helps determine the ISO performance of a camera. The second phase of testing involved getting outside the studio and shooting a real-world scenario. We included the

usual rundown of several kinds of still life, lots of landscape, some macro along with people shots. For our low light testing, we resorted to taking a lot of street shots at generally high ISO and wide apertures.

Video performance was tested indoors and outdoors. The outdoor filming allowed us to gauge the dynamic range and audio prowess of the cameras whereas the indoor test allowed us to see how well the sensor could curtail and control noise.

For detailed tested images head to: http://digit.in/dgt_0213_adv_pns

and external flash support. What it does have, however, is a pop-up flash with a novel hinge design that allows the user to tilt it backwards to allow for a nice bounce from a nearby ceiling. We found that this ability to tilt the flash for different kinds of fills allowed us to achieve a rather pleasing image, one with a good balance of ambient and flash. With respect to design, we're sort of on the fence with whether we should go for something that's slim and pocketable, or let the bulk of some of these cameras slide just because they have powerful imaging capabilities. The Nikon Coolpix P7700 comes to mind here, which has served us really well in many awry conditions. Its only downside was the slightly slow AF and that it's incredibly bulky, but that's probably because of the fully articulated screen. However, if something bulky is absolutely out of the question, then the RX100 or the LX7 are worth a look. Speaking of features and design, we'd like to make a special mention of the Fujifilm X10, which employs the most unique camera design of the bunch. It has a rangefinder-like design and it ships with a fast f/2-2.8 lens while sporting a decently sized 2/3-inch sensor which Fuji claims will give DSLR-like results. It comes

with modestly fast AF, but one that takes a little getting used to along with the film simulation modes that we absolutely love. Fujifilm might not be making the Velvia film anymore, but you might get that same look with the X10. Overall, we feel that it can be hard to pick just one camera to trump them all based in just features, but our hearts are strongly set on the RX100 which not only has a large sensor, but also a fast starting aperture and comes with a tilting flash all wrapped up in a neat, sturdy plastic body that will fit into most pockets.

Ergonomics and build

A lot of money is spent by camera makers to achieve the perfect placement of buttons

and indents when it comes to their cameras. The companies truly do want the camera to be an extension of your arm, and therefore, much research goes into designing its curves to flow naturally with the human grip. We felt that in all the cameras we used, the Canon PowerShot G15 had the best blend of size and comfort. Its grip is designed and the buttons are all within the thumb's reach, except the playback button which is right at the top, next to the viewfinder. The worst in our opinion was the Panasonic LX7, whose buttons not only felt like cheap toys, but also felt weirdly spaced. The RX100 is designed simply as an elegant slab of plastic with rounded edges with no real

gripping options. If you're comfortable with holding the camera with just your thumb and index finger, then you shouldn't have any problems with the RX100, otherwise we strongly recommend looking into a third party grip option. It's a toss up between the RX100 and the G15, slimmer design and pocketability vs superior ergonomics and function. The Panasonic LX7 and the Canon PowerShot S110 both fit well into the pocket, but follow the same design ethos as the RX100. Overall, if we had to choose, the RX100 would be our choice because it's super light, so holding it with the 'thumb-index-finger-combination' doesn't hurt at all, it has a large sensor and a fast aperture and most of all, it can easily be tucked away not only into a pocket, but also any reasonably small crevice in a backpack or purse.

Performance

Now THIS is the real meat of the show! With every manufacturer's best cameras laid out in front of us, it all comes down to which camera can deliver the best images and videos. Our studio tests revealed that the Canon PowerShot G1x was hands down the best at controlling noise. Our



Sony RX100